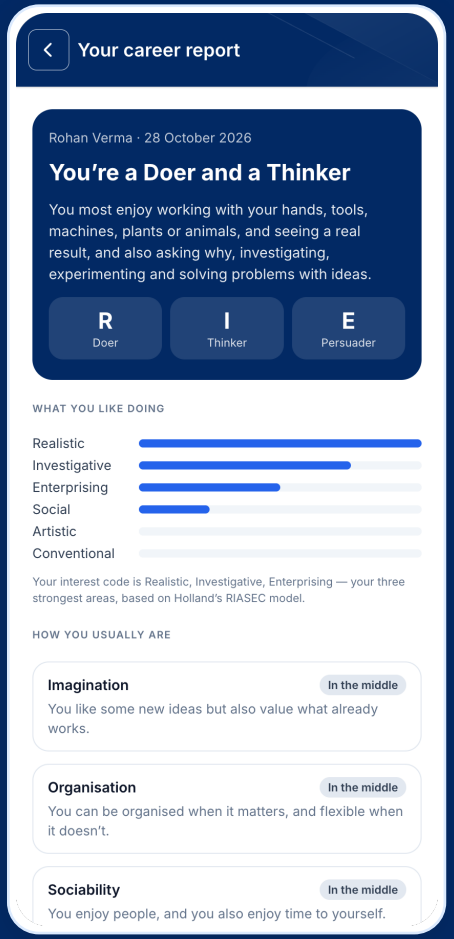
Every student deserves a career conversation

HPC Career — the Holistic Progress Card that becomes every student's career passbook: a 10-minute test, a report they can read, real routes from Class 10, and a record of their whole journey.

Code for a Billion 2026 · Impact area 01 · Education



Crores of students choose a stream with almost no guidance

24.8 crore

students in Indian schools

UDISE+ 2023-24

93%

of 10,000 students surveyed knew only 7 career options — out of about 250

Mindler survey, 2019

< 1 in 10

low-income Class 9–12 students had ever received career guidance (9.36%)

Bharat Career Aspiration Report 2024

Sources: Ministry of Education, UDISE+ 2023-24 · Mindler survey of 10,000 students aged 14–21 (2019) · Bharat Career Aspiration Report 2024, UNICEF YuWaah & iDreamCareer (4,968 students, 25 states)

The big decision comes at 15, mostly on advice from home

Who students say shapes their career choice

30% Family members — the top influence

13% School teachers

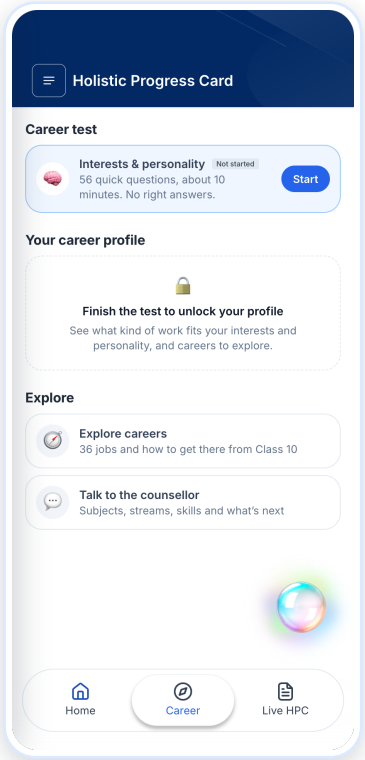
Most others: friends, marks and what relatives did

NEP 2020 replaced marks-only report cards with the Holistic Progress Card

PARAKH sent the HPC to every state in 2023. It describes the whole child — but it stops short of the question every Class 10 student faces: what next?

Sources: Bharat Career Aspiration Report 2024 (UNICEF YuWaah & iDreamCareer) · NCERT PARAKH Holistic Progress Card, shared with states and UTs in September 2023

HPC Career: the progress card that helps students choose what's next



Career test

56 quick questions on interests and personality, about 10 minutes, one per screen.

A report they can read

An interest code, strengths, six careers that fit and the next steps.

Explore careers

36 careers with the route to each from Class 10 in India.

Ask the counsellor

A chat for questions about streams, subjects and exams.

Plus a class view for teachers — who has finished, and where the class's interests lie.

HPC becomes every student’s career passbook

Just as a bank passbook records every deposit, HPC Career records every step of a student’s career journey — from Class 9 to Class 12.

Every test, year after year

Watch interests grow and change from Class 9 to 12.

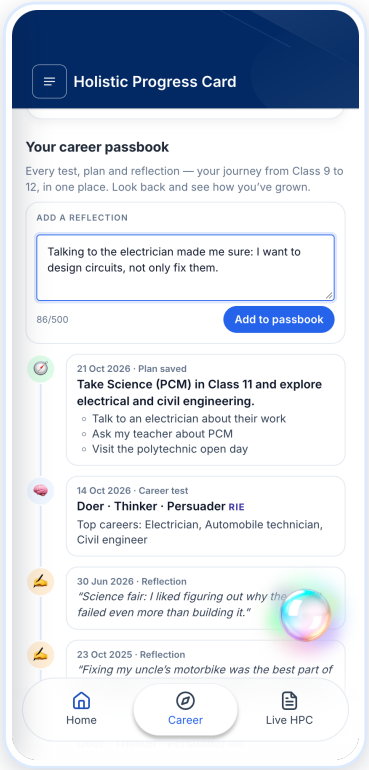
Every plan they make

Goals and next steps, saved and seen by their teacher.

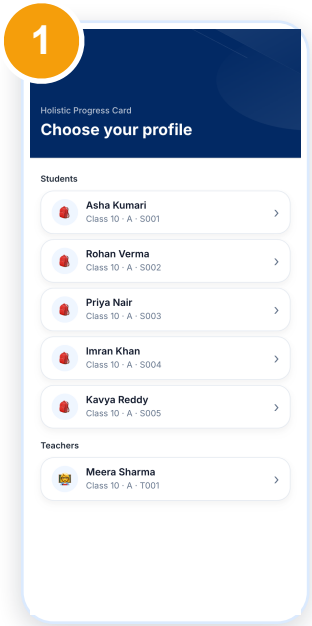
Their own reflections

What they learnt about themselves, in their own words.

Students look back, see how they have grown, and decide with evidence — not guesswork.

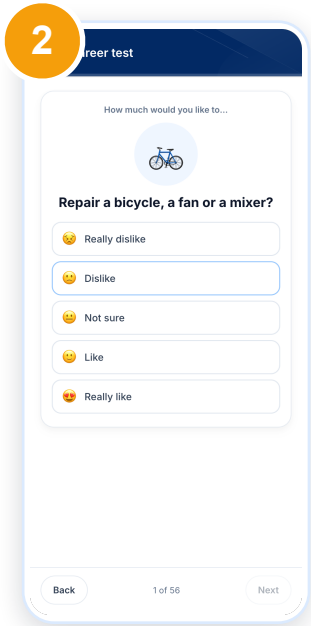


A student’s journey in four steps



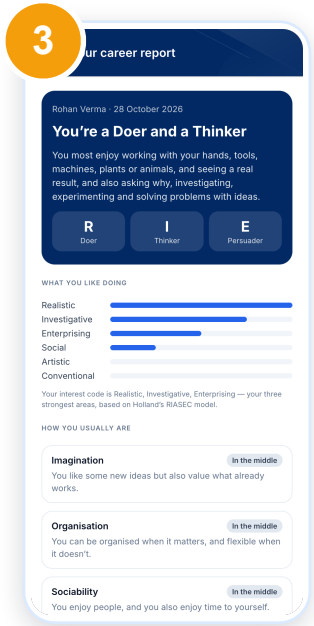
Pick a profile

One tap, no password yet



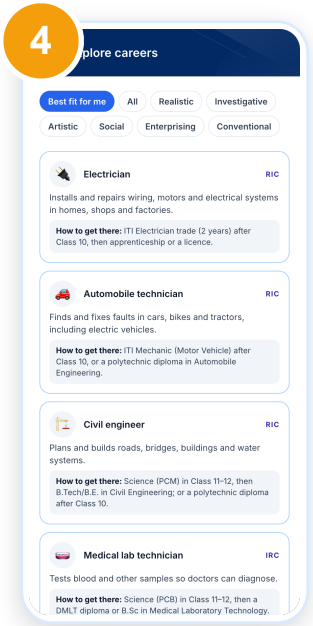
Take the test

One question per screen



Read the report

Interest code and strengths



Explore careers

Best fit first, with routes

RIASEC: six ways people like to work

Holland’s model: people thrive in work that matches what they enjoy. A student’s three strongest types become their interest code.

R Realistic
Doer

Tools, machines, the outdoors

Electrician · Civil engineer

I Investigative
Thinker

Science and solving problems

Doctor · Data analyst

A Artistic
Creator

Art, words, music and design

Designer · Architect

S Social
Helper

Teaching, caring, helping people

Teacher · Nurse

E Enterprising
Persuader

Leading, selling, starting things

Entrepreneur · Lawyer

C Conventional
Organiser

Order, numbers and detail

Accountant · Bank officer

Based on John Holland’s theory of vocational choice (RIASEC). The app’s 36 interest questions are original and not yet validated.

The test: 56 questions, about 10 minutes

36 interest questions

Six per RIASEC type, about everyday activities — repairing a fan, helping a child study.

20 personality questions

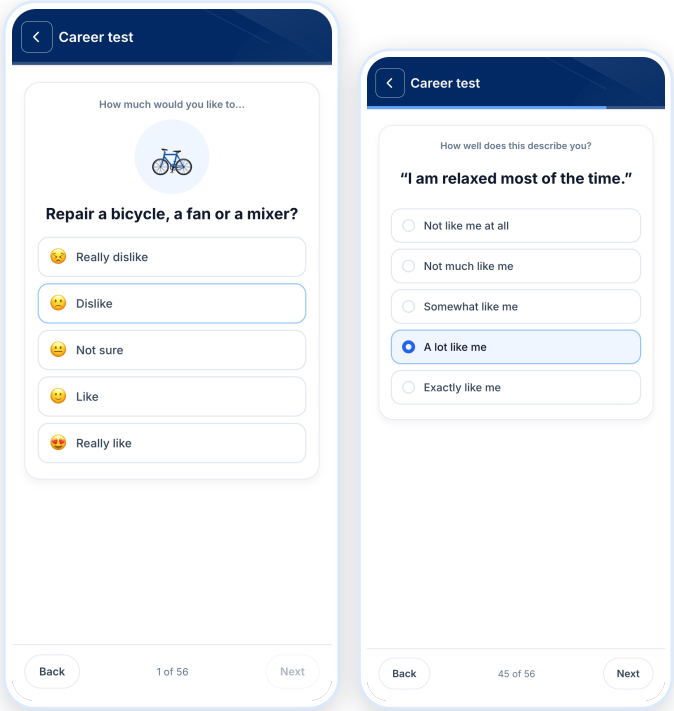
The Mini-IPIP Big Five, from the public-domain International Personality Item Pool.

Made for a shared phone

Big tap targets, an emoji per activity, progress kept through a reload or a phone call.

Scored on the server

The phone sends answers; the server scores and saves them, so nobody can edit a result.



Psychometrics, done responsibly

What we measure

- Interests: 36 everyday activities, six per RIASEC type, from “really dislike” to “really like”.
- Personality: the Big Five, with the 20-item public-domain Mini-IPIP.

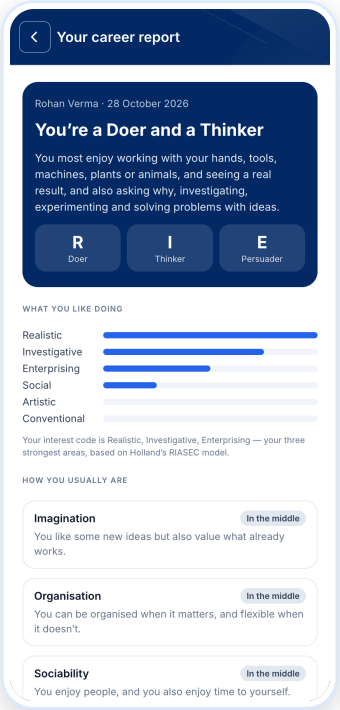
How it is scored

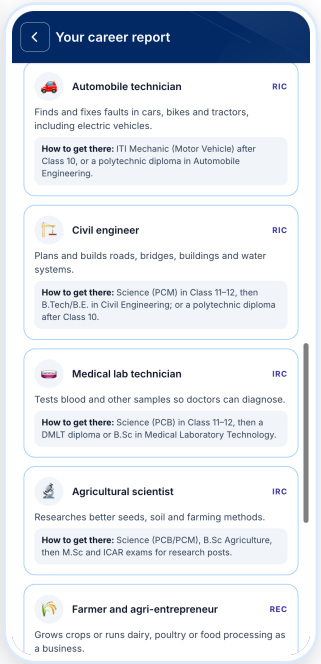
- Each type scores the share of “really like” it got; the top three form the interest code.
- Careers are ranked by how well their RIASEC code matches the student’s.
- Scored on the server only.

Safeguards

- No ranking against other students.
- Every trait framed as a strength; Neuroticism shown as Calmness.
- Flags “same answer to everything”.
- Called a starting point, not a verdict.

A report written for the student, not the counsellor





1. **Their interest code**
   e.g. Creator · Helper · Thinker, with what each means.

2. **Strengths, never weaknesses**
   Every level of every trait is a way of being that suits some work. Neuroticism is shown as Calmness.

3. **Six careers that fit**
   Each with what the job is and how to get there from Class 10.

4. **Next steps — and a printout**
   What to do this month, and a print-ready page to discuss at home.

How it guides a student, step by step

1 Discover

Take the 10-minute test on any phone.

2 Understand

See their interest code and strengths in plain words.

3 Explore

36 careers ranked by fit, each with the route from Class 10.

4 Plan

Choose next steps for this year and save the plan.

5 Talk

Print the report; discuss it with family and teachers.

6 Reflect

Write in the passbook; retake each year and see how they have grown.

Every step is recorded in the student’s career passbook.

Teachers see the whole class at a glance

Who has finished

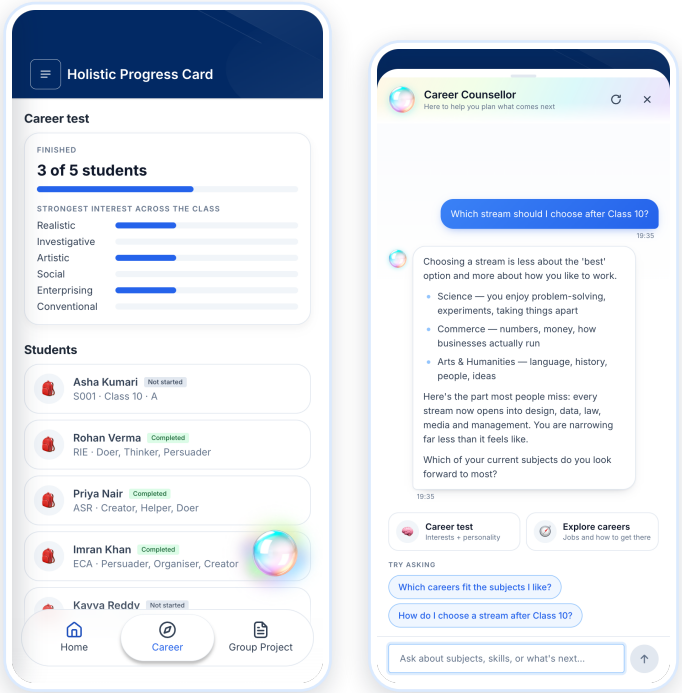
Follow up with the students who haven’t.

Where the class’s interests lie

Plan career talks, visits and subject choices around them.

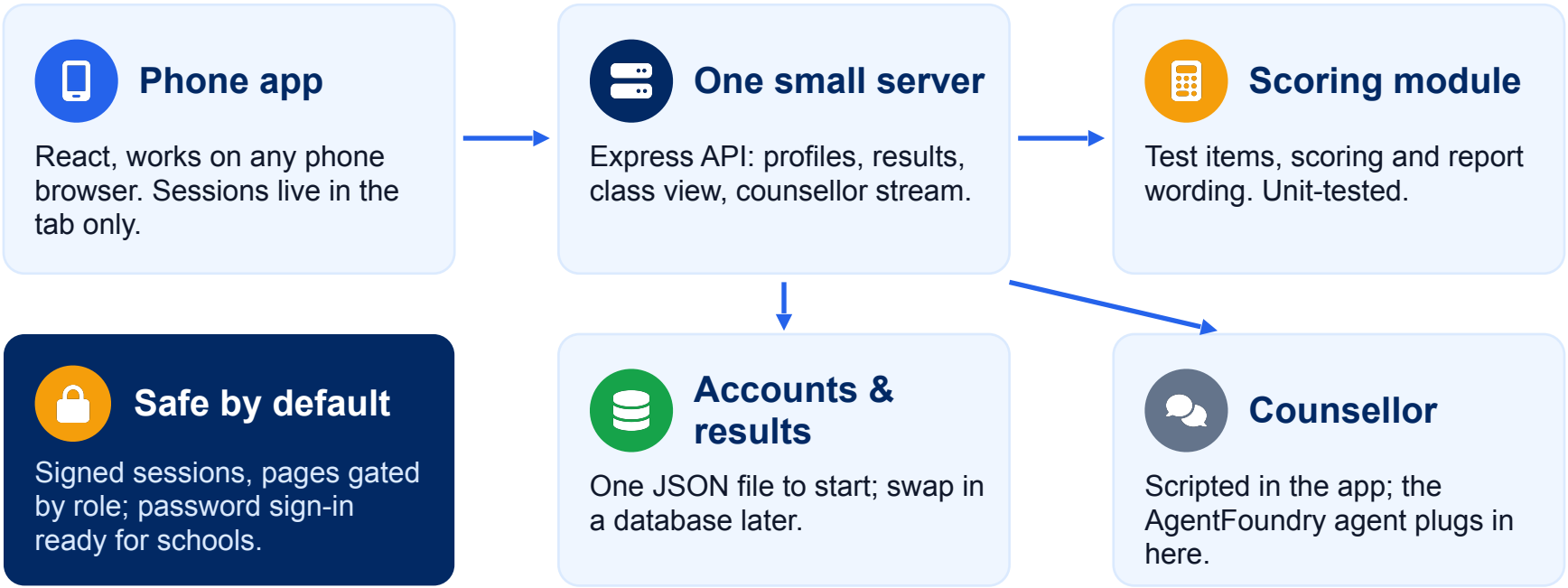
Each student’s code

A ready starting point for a one-to-one or a parent meeting.



Class view · counsellor chat

Simple to run, open by design



Open source under MIT · github.com/om-1115/hpc-career-agent · 24 automated tests for scoring, the API and the agent's tools

Honest about what a 10-minute test can say



A starting point

The report says so on the page. The interest questions are new and not yet validated.



Strength-based language

No trait is a flaw. Scores show more or less for this student, not a ranking.



Open content

Personality items are public domain; interest items, careers and wording are ours and MIT-licensed.



Private by default

Only the student and their teacher see a result. Nothing is kept on a shared phone after sign-out.

How we will show impact

Size

Built for any school with a phone and a browser — the 24.8 crore students in Indian schools.

Severity

A stream chosen at 15 shapes the next decade; fewer than 1 in 10 low-income students get guidance today.

Quality

Tested scoring and API, accessible screens, works on a shared phone, open source.

Proven impact

A pilot school: students who finish, reports discussed at home, teacher use in subject choice.

Mapped to the Code for a Billion judging criteria: size, severity, quality of the solution and proven impact (25% each)

What comes next



Now

Built and open

Test, report, careers, counsellor, teacher view.



Built and evaluated

An AI counsellor agent

In AgentFoundry: reads the result, finds careers, saves a plan. All 10 evals pass.



Next

Into the app, then a pilot

Agent in the app's chat, then a partner school, measuring use and outcomes.



Then

Hindi and more languages

The test, report and careers in regional languages.

Try it today

github.com/om-1115/hpc-career-agent

npm run seed:demo, then npm run dev:all, and pick a student or teacher profile

Open source · MIT · Code for a Billion 2026

